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A Hamitic kingdom in the center of Africa

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Chapter 3 Short Historical Account of the Hamitic Invasion of Ruanda

This historical piece survived the Ruchunchu disaster 88, when fire consumed the many pieces and objects belonging to the royal wardrobe. The aforementioned vestment is none other than a colobus pelt (inkomo), such as the Batutsi chiefs and kings used to wear.

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This garment was rather small, and as a result it is called derisively in the story "the overly short garment" that did not match the size of its owner (1). Laughter and jokes come readily to the Blacks.

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As far as we know, no outstanding event took place under the three following monarchs.

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Under the thirty-first, Chyilima II Ludjugira, on the other hand, the struggle with the Barundi was renewed. This war is the subject of a long narrative embellished and distorted by legend. According to it, the Banyarwanda declared war on the Barundi as the result of a drought and in order to bring it to an end. Under the same reign, an alien tribe invaded the Bugoyi, on the east shore of Lake Kivu, and was repelled with great difficulty. The historical character of this second episode is better preserved. "It concerns a people,"

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so the elders narrate, "of light complexion, who spoke a language different from ours and who built their houses differently."

They had the peculiar habit of covering their dwellings with earth. Their tools, axes, and hoes, were better wrought and more durable than those of the autochthonous inhabitants. They were designated as "Those who cover their roofs with earth" (*Abassakazataka*) or the "Mutes" (*Ibiragi*) because of their incomprehensible language. The newcomers had settled in the Bugoyi province, which is separated from the Nduga by the forest, and they were soon quarreling with the  71 few native dwellers who had settled in a small part of that volcanic region. It was in vain that the latter banded together to repel the strangers. The "Mutes" remained victorious and 89 repelled their assailants. Then Chyilima's help was requested, and he sent an army to their aid. The intruders were hewed to pieces, and the survivors fled to the north and never returned.

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1. The literal meaning is more vivid and "spicy." Ntizihih' amabuno!

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